

Chengzu Li

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Education

2023 - Now **University of Cambridge**
PhD student supervised by Prof. Anna Korhonen, Dr. Ivan Vulić and Prof. Serge Belongie.
Fully funded by Cambridge Trust.
Visiting student at Belongie Lab (2025.8 - 2025.11)

2022 - 2023 **University of Cambridge**
M.Phil. in Advanced Computer Science (Distinction 81.7/100)
Supervised by Prof. Simone Teufel. Fully funded by Cambridge Trust.

2018 - 2022 **Xi'an Jiaotong University**
Bachelor of Engineering in Automation (91.96/100, top 5%). Minor in Fintech.

2021 **University of Hong Kong**
Exchange student in Computer Engineering (4.08/4.3)

Publications

Conferences

(* indicates equal contribution)

2026 **Visual Planning: Let's Think Only with Images**
Yi Xu*, Chengzu Li*, Han Zhou*, Xingchen Wan, Caiqi Zhang, Anna Korhonen, Ivan Vulić
ICLR [Github]
- Featured at X(Twitter), Medium and etc.(CHN)
- Community influence with over 290 Github stars

Deforming Videos to Masks: Flow Matching for Referring Video Segmentation
Zanyi Wang, Dengyang Jiang, Liuzhuozheng Li, Sizhe Dang, Chengzu Li, Harry Yang, Guang Dai, Mengmeng Wang, Jingdong Wang
ICLR [Github]

2025 **Information Loss in Vision-Language Models**
Wenyan Li, Raphael Tang, Chengzu Li, Caiqi Zhang, Ivan Vulić, Anders Søgaard
EMNLP Findings [Github]

Enriching Patent Claim Generation with European Patent Dataset
Lekang Jiang, Chengzu Li, Stefan Goetz
EMNLP Findings

Imagine While Reasoning in Space: Multimodal Visualization-of-Thought
Chengzu Li*, Wenshan Wu*, Huanyu Zhang, Yan Xia, Shaoguang Mao, Li Dong, Ivan Vulić, Furu Wei
ICML [Github]
- Featured at IEEE Spectrum, TWIML AI Podcast and etc.(CHN)

- Community influence over 60 Github stars

Large Language Models are Miscalibrated In-Context Learners

Chengzu Li, Han Zhou, Goran Glavaš, Anna Korhonen, Ivan Vulić

ACL Findings [Github]

2024

TOPVIEWRS: Vision-Language Models as Top-View Spatial Reasoners

Chengzu Li*, Caiqi Zhang*, Han Zhou, Nigel Collier, Anna Korhonen, Ivan Vulić

EMNLP Oral [Github]

- Featured at **TWIML AI Podcast**

- Non-archival at ACL 2023 SpLU Robo Workshop (**Oral**), ECCV 2024 Eval-Fomo Workshop

Semantic Map-based Generation of Navigation Instructions

Chengzu Li, Chao Zhang, Simone Teufel, Rama Sanand Doddipatla, Svetlana Stoyanchev

COLING

2023

Generating Data for Symbolic Language with Large Language Models

Jiacheng Ye, Chengzu Li, Lingpeng Kong, Tao Yu

EMNLP [Github]

Binding Language Models in Symbolic Languages

Zhoujun Cheng*, Tianbao Xie*, Peng Shi, Chengzu Li, Rahul Nadkarni, Yushi Hu, Caiming Xiong, Dragomir Radev, Mari Ostendorf, Luke Zettlemoyer, Noah A. Smith, Tao Yu

ICLR Spotlight [Github]

2022

UnifiedSKG: Unifying and Multi-Tasking Structured Knowledge Grounding with Text-to-Text Language Models

Tianbao Xie*, Chen Henry Wu*, Peng Shi, Ruiqi Zhong, Torsten Scholak, Michihiro Yasunaga, Chien-Sheng Wu, Ming Zhong, Pengcheng Yin, Sida I. Wang, Victor Zhong, Bailin Wang, Chengzu Li, Connor Boyle, Ansong Ni, Ziyu Yao, Dragomir Radev, Caiming Xiong, Lingpeng Kong, Rui Zhang, Noah A. Smith, Luke Zettlemoyer, Tao Yu

EMNLP Oral [Github]

Pre-prints

Thinking in Frames: How Visual Context and Test-Time Scaling Empower Video Reasoning

Chengzu Li*, Zanyi Wang*, Jiaang Li*, Yi Xu, Han Zhou, Huanyu Zhang, Ruichuan An, Dengyang Jiang, Zhaochong An, Ivan Vulić, Serge Belongie, Anna Korhonen

Latent Sketchpad: Autoregressive Visual Latent Generation for Interpretable Visual Thoughts in MLLMs

Huanyu Zhang*, Wenshan Wu*, Chengzu Li, Ning Shang, Yan Xia, Yangyu Huang, Yifan Zhang, Li Dong, Zhang Zhang, Liang Wang, Tieniu Tan, Furu Wei

11PLUS-BENCH: Demystifying Multimodal LLM Spatial Reasoning with Cognitive-Inspired Analysis

Chengzu Li, Wenshan Wu, Huanyu Zhang, Qingtao Li, Zeyu Gao, Yan Xia, José Hernández-Orallo, Ivan Vulić, Furu Wei

Scaling and Beyond: Advancing Spatial Reasoning in MLLMs Requires New Recipes

Huanyu Zhang*, Chengzu Li*, Wenshan Wu, Shaoguang Mao, Yifan Zhang, Haochen Tian, Ivan Vulić, Zhang Zhang, Liang Wang, Tieniu Tan, Furu Wei

Reinforcement Learning for Better Verbalized Confidence in Long-Form Generation

Caiqi Zhang*, Xiaochen Zhu*, Chengzu Li, Nigel Collier, Andreas Vlachos

Professional Experiences

2024	GenAI Group, Microsoft Research Research Intern
2023	Toshiba Cambridge Research Laboratory Research Intern
2021	Shanghai Artificial Intelligence Lab Research Intern HKU CS Research Internship Programme Research Intern

Academic Service

Paper Reviewing

NLP	ACL ARR 2024, 2025
AI	ICLR 2026, ICML 2026
CV	CVPR 2026

Selected Awards & Grants

2025	One of three nominations by University of Cambridge for the Apple AI/ML PhD Fellowship Postgraduate Research Fund from Jesus College, Cambridge Lambda Research Grant (\$2000 USD in GPU credits)
2024	Postgraduate Research Fund from Jesus College, Cambridge Scholar of Jesus College, Cambridge (for outstanding academic performance)
2023	PhD Scholarship from Cambridge Trust (Fully-Funded)
2022	Masters Scholarship from Cambridge Trust (Fully-Funded)
2019	National Scholarship (Top 1%, highest honor for undergraduates in China)

Media Coverage & Presentations

2025	Invited Talk at HKUST (GZ): Reason with Multimodal Minds in Space JiQiZhiXin (CHN): Thinking with Images Alone: RL Fosters a New Paradigm for Reasoning Models XinZhiYuan (CHN): Beyond CoT! Directly Visualize the Multimodal Reasoning Process TWIML AI Podcast with Sam Charrington: Multimodal Visualization-of-Thought IEEE Spectrum: “Thinking” Visually Boosts AI Problem Solving
2024	BMVA: Trustworthy Multimodal Learning with Foundation Models